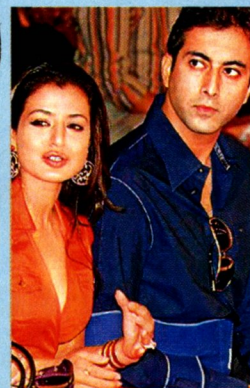




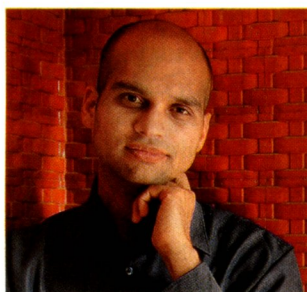
SHIRYA PATIL SHINDE

HOT HOOK-UPS

Young Bollywood fell in love and thankfully didn't want the world to believe they were 'just friends.' **Deepika Padukone** and Lucky Boy **Ranbir Kapoor** (left) snogged at the airport, **Shilpa Shetty** and **Raj Kundra** (extreme left) did the temple trail and **Amisha Patel** and **Kanav Puri** (below) couldn't stop talking about each other. And after her ageing ex-boyfriend blurted to the tabloids, **Kangana Ranaut** moved on to **Adhyayan Suman**.



FOTOCORP



MANOJAR DEODHAR

LOSERS BECOME WINNERS

The biggest ticket on TV belonged to the I'm-famous-for-doing-nothing group. After living on the fringes on TV land, **Raja Chowdhary** (bottom right) beat up his famous wife but raked in votes on *Bigg Boss 2*. **Rahul Mahajan** (bottom left), fresh from a drug scandal and an even fresher divorce, spent a good part of 2008 in front of real judges. But reality TV almost made him a prime time hero. On another show, **Abhishek Awasthi**, best known as drama queen **Rakhi Sawant**'s ex-squeeze, danced as a 'celebrity'. And the crown prince of the clique: a dhabawala, **Ashutosh Kaushik**, whose sole calling has been reality shows. Say hello to India's Jade Goodys.

BOOKED FOR NOW

Another Indian author roared in 2008. **Arvind Adiga**'s debut novel *The White Tiger*, lifted the veil off India's superficial success and went on to win the Man Booker Prize. The 34-year-old's writing evoked some very strong commentary—not all of it positive. As the book's sales went up, accessibility to Adiga went down.

